

**THE AXIS OF ISLAMIST
TERROR SHIFTS TO THE
BRITISH CAPITAL WITH
HOMEGROWN IMMIGRANT
RADICALS PROLIFERATING
AS MUSLIM ANGER GROWS**

■ By Jason Burke in London

On the streets of London's Finsbury Park last week, once known as the hotbed of Islamic radicalism in the UK, the sense of relief was palpable. Outside the Pakistani restaurant on Stroud Green Road, Ahmed Hafiz shook his head. "Arabs, mate," he said. "They are to blame. Angry bunch. Nothing to do with us Brits, Thankfully." Hafiz, 31, was not the only one to be happy that those arrested by the police for their suspected role in the failed double car bombing in London on June 30 and the subsequent attempt to ram a petrol-filled car into Glasgow Airport came from overseas. Bashir Ahmad, a Scottish National Party member of Parliament, said that when a meeting of Glasgow Muslims was told by a minister that the arrested men were not Scottish, "you could hear the collect-

ive sighs of relief around the room". The British Muslim community, which has been living in a profound crisis of identity and faith since the 7/7 bombings that killed 52 two years ago, knew that, for once, the questions about its loyalty to the country, to fellow citizens, to the *ummah*, would not be asked with quite such searching and uncomfortable persistence.

Yet, for the security services dedicated to protecting the UK from the

continuing and severe threat of terrorist attack, there was little to be pleased about. For one, there were the questions to be asked about why they had not detected the plot earlier. The suspects, five from the Middle East and three from India, were not on domestic intelligence service MI5's database of over 1,600 individuals in Britain identified as preparing for terrorist attacks here or abroad. And though there were apparently 'traces' of them on a bigger

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IN THE NAME OF GOD A mosque in east London which many of those suspected of being part of a plot to blow up trans-atlantic airliners attended (left); an Islamic society holds a prayer session